
CASE REVIEW - HALE, EDMUND (DECEASED)

On the morning of 7 January the director of the Ashcombe Observatory was found dead at the foot of a ladder, inside a telescope dome that had been bolted from the inside. The caretaker forced the door. The file was closed as an accidental fall.

His sister does not believe it. Neither, on paper, does the pathologist. The coroner has allowed a review.

YOUR TASK

Decide whether Edmund Hale's death was an accident. If it was not, **name everyone responsible**, and show your working.

This is an Expert file. Not every document in it is what it says it is.

HOW THIS WORKS

1 · THE FILE OPENS IN THREE PHASES

Read what the memo names, write down your theory, then open the next bundle.

2 · LOGS DON'T LIE. PEOPLE MIGHT. SO MIGHT A PRINTOUT.

If a statement and a log disagree, the log is right. **But a log is only as honest as the person who printed it.** Ask who supplied each record, and whether it is complete.

3 · FIVE AUTHORITIES

Ten lines of inquiry are open. Solo and pairs get **five**; three or more players get six. Several of them return nothing you need.

4 · WRITE IT DOWN AS YOU GO

Every step on the Case Resolution Sheet needs a citation. Your final finding may need more than one name.

5 · ACCUSING

Two wrong accusations are allowed. Each costs 10 points and returns a *Reconsider* slip. The third is final. Then open **ENVELOPE S-1**.

OPEN LINES OF INQUIRY

Ten authorities are available to this review. Each may be exercised once. Tick the box when spent and open the matching sealed slip.

SPENT	NO.	AUTHORITY	DIRECTED TO
☐	01	Obtain the cloud copy of the dome door log direct from the lock manufacturer	KeyLine Systems
☐	02	Seize the control-room workstation session log	Digital Forensics
☐	03	Forensic examination of the brass counterweight , EX-01	Forensic Science
☐	04	Obtain bank and telephone records - T. Brackley	Bank / carrier
☐	05	Examine Professor Hale's laptop , EX-02, and his email drafts	Digital Forensics
☐	06	Verify Dr Okafor's travel and hotel in Geneva	Airline / hotel
☐	07	Obtain the doorbell camera at Mrs Hale's home, Hallow Lane	Householder
☐	08	Obtain bus CCTV and ticket data - K. Nowak	Valley Buses
☐	09	Commission a second pathologist to review the head injuries	Home Office pathologist
☐	10	Obtain the weather station and sky record for the night	Observatory archive

ADVICE FROM THE UNIT

Before you spend, ask what in the file made you want it, and whether you already hold the answer. Clearing a person you have already cleared is a luxury.

CASE RESOLUTION SHEET

Complete **before** making a final accusation. Cite evidence by document reference (e.g. B-1, D-1, SLIP 01). A step with no citation scores nothing.

1. 1 · CAUSE - HOW DID HE DIE, AND WAS IT A FALL?EVIDENCE **2. 2 · TIME - WHEN WAS HE LAST ALIVE, AND WHEN DID HE DIE?**EVIDENCE **3. 3 · THE LOCKED ROOM - WAS THE DOME REALLY BOLTED WHEN IT WAS FOUND?**EVIDENCE **4. 4 · THE FORGERY - WHICH RECORD CANNOT BE TRUSTED, AND HOW DO YOU KNOW?**EVIDENCE **5. 5 · THE KILLER - WHO WAS IN THE DOME WITH HIM, AND WHAT PROVES IT?**EVIDENCE **6. 6 · THE COVER-UP - WHO MADE IT LOOK LIKE AN ACCIDENT?**EVIDENCE

FINDINGS ON EACH PERSON

Record each as Cleared, Suspect, Killer or Accomplice, with the evidence you rely on. A person is cleared only when a document puts them beyond the doubt.

PERSON

FINDING

EVIDENCE RELIED ON

BRACKLEY, Thomas

Caretaker

LINDQVIST, Dr Ivo

Visiting researcher

OKAFOR, Dr Miriam

Deputy director

HALE, Ellen

Wife of the deceased

NOWAK, Kasia

Doctoral student

MOTIVE (OPTIONAL - SCORES NOTHING)

ACCUSATIONS

NO.

NAMED

OUTCOME

1

2

3 -

FINAL

FINAL ACCUSATION

On the evidence recorded above, the death of Edmund Hale was:

☐ ACCIDENTAL ☐ MURDER

and, if murder, it was committed by, and covered up by:

NOW OPEN ENVELOPE S-1